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China Battery Materials

Lithium into 4th week of July - A jumpy week

CITI'S TAKE

Lithium market has been jumpy in the last couple of days, factoring in the bearish sentiment of re-balancing supply-demand dynamics in 2027 (indicating an accelerating supply if no further supply disruption by that time), whilst near-term fundamentals should extend resilience as a material scale of new battery capacity should be coming on-stream in Aug-Sep (Citi estimates CATL's battery production pipeline up ~mid-to-high single digit MoM in Aug-26). For JXW mine, our cross-check with industry contacts last week suggests JXW mine has resumed production and we estimate the mine is under-ramping up and current utilization rate is <50%, indicating weekly output is less than 1kt LCE at present (vs 2-2.5kt LCE per week if returning full operation). We await more battery chain & JXW mine updates in the upcoming CATL 1H26 results call at 8pm this Friday; join us via the [registration](#).

Weekly wrap-up: Lithium **ASP** was in the downtrend **WoW** last week. Among that, Li₂CO₃ and LiOH ASP is quoted at Rmb146.5k/t and Rmb134.5k/t as of 23th July respectively, vs Rmb151k/t and Rmb137.8k/t as of 16th July. **Production wise**, China Li₂CO₃ production was -3% **WoW** at 23,868 tons last week. Among that, output from brine, lepidolite, spodumene, and recycle was +3%/+8%/-7%/-1%**WoW** respectively. **Inventory wise**, total inventory of Li₂CO₃ came in at 86,911 tons this week (-4% **WoW**/-2,726 tons **WoW**). Within that, inventory of downstream players (mainly cathode makers), smelters, and others (mainly battery makers and traders) were -2%, flattish, -7% **WoW** to 50,708 tons, 13,291 tons, and 22,912 tons, respectively.

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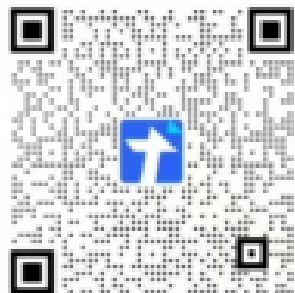
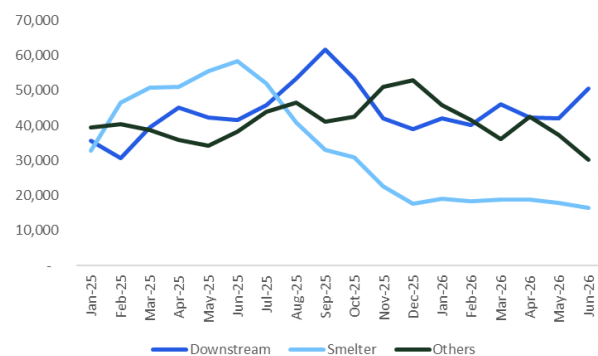
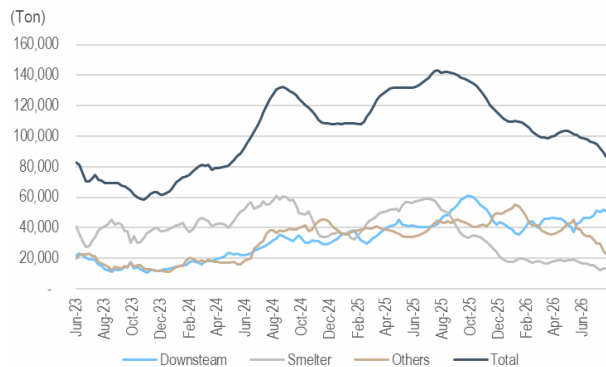


Figure 1. Lithium carbonate monthly inventory



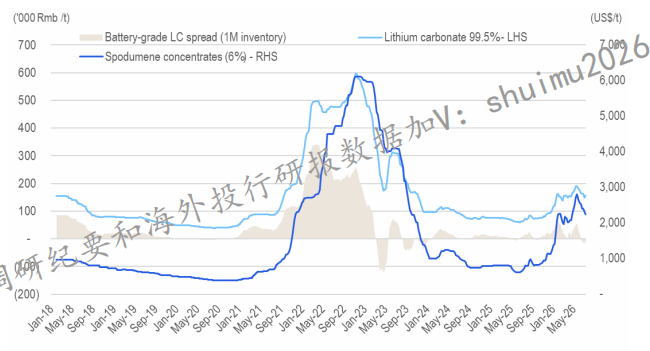
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Figure 2. Lithium carbonate weekly inventory



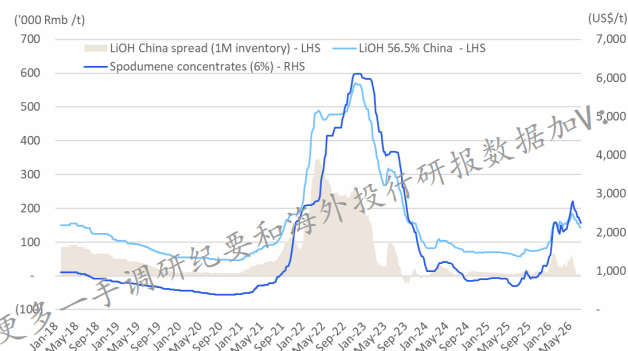
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Figure 3. Spread of battery-grade LC (assume 1M inventory)



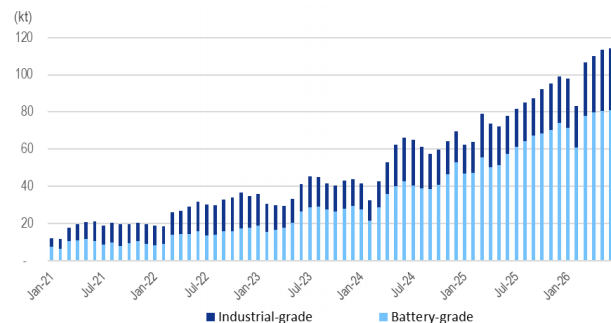
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Figure 4. Spread of battery-grade LC (assume 1M inventory)



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Figure 5. Lithium carbonate monthly production



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Figure 6. Lithium carbonate weekly production



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